

Read the work before redesigning the platform.

Build a shared, evidence-based view of the customer journey, product architecture, operating constraints, and decisions that currently create or destroy leverage.

OUTCOME

A role charter and platform reality map the team recognizes as true.

Customer and user discovery

- Observe frontline use across knowledge, verification, live SOP, and time-motion workflows
- Interview champions, skeptics, partners, developers, implementation, support, sales, and customer success
- Trace first access to first useful and first verified value
- Collect recurring annoyances, workarounds, and adoption friction

Technical and product reading

- Map data flows, ontologies, model services, evaluation, APIs, identity, security, observability, and integration boundaries
- Inventory product-line forks and shared services
- Review roadmap commitments, technical debt, incidents, overrides, and support burden
- Clarify current decision rights

DELIVERABLES

Mandate charter

Business outcome, platform boundary, decision rights, non-goals, and first 120-day success evidence.

First-value journey map

Where access, data, setup, integration, trust, user behavior, and customer ownership slow value.

Platform boundary map

Shared substrate, product-specific capabilities, customer-specific variation, and unresolved ownership.

Annoyance register

Concrete builder and end-user friction ranked by frequency, consequence, strategic relevance, and solvability.

EARLY OPERATING CADENCE

Weekly product/engineering decision review · customer signal review · architecture and AI threshold review · short written decision records · visible risk and commitment map.

Define the work address. Prove it against real customer value.

DAYS 31-60 · DEFINE

Create the minimum shared contract that makes the portfolio legible.

Architecture and product principles

- Draft canonical work identity and event vocabulary
- Define standardize vs. federate decision criteria
- Map product surfaces to shared platform services
- Set AI threshold, authority, fallback, and recovery taxonomy

Portfolio and roadmap

- Reframe roadmap items by customer outcome, platform leverage, trust, and learning
- Identify dependencies and stop/hold decisions
- Write builder-facing platform narrative
- Select bounded in-market experiments

DAYS 61-90 · PROVE

Run experiments that test both customer outcome and reusable platform leverage.

Experiment design

- Use a credible baseline rather than an empty prototype
- Define decision consequence, data rights, model scope, owner, and stop conditions
- Instrument activation, trust, use, outcome, economics, and support burden
- Test developer and implementation experience

Decision outcomes

- Formalize shared capability when reuse is evidenced
- Federate legitimate domain variation
- Revise weak hypotheses quickly
- Stop work that cannot earn customer or platform value

DELIVERABLES BY DAY 90

Work Address v0.1 · evidence/threshold taxonomy · roadmap decision matrix · platform capability narrative · instrumented experiment readouts · recommended standardize/federate/stop decisions.

Convert the proof into a durable product operating cadence.

OUTCOME

A legible roadmap, monthly scorecard, decision architecture, and GTM story tied to customer outcomes.

Institutionalize

- Publish platform strategy and roadmap narrative
- Clarify product, architecture, model, customer, and release decision rights
- Launch monthly KPI and in-market experiment review
- Install model/evaluation and customer-learning cadence

Scale alignment

- Equip Sales and Customer Success with outcome and platform-expansion narratives
- Support strategic QBR and enterprise architecture conversations
- Publish builder-friendly platform contracts and examples
- Define next two quarters of platform bets, holds, and discovery

MONTHLY SCORECARD

LENS	QUESTIONS	EXAMPLE MEASURES TO BASELINE INTERNALLY
First value	How quickly does a customer reach a useful verified outcome?	Activation elapsed time, setup steps, implementation effort, first successful workflow
Leverage	Does new work strengthen or fork the platform?	Standard service use, reusable integrations/evaluations, exception burden, duplication
Trust	Can customers rely on the decision posture?	Confidence, latency, overrides, false outcomes, fallback/recovery, model drift
Adoption	Does the product remove a real annoyance and fit the work?	Repeat use, completion, builder activity, workflow pull, support friction
Outcome	Did the customer operation move?	Agreed operational KPI such as time, rework, defects, adherence, proficiency, or flow
Economics	Is value durable and scalable?	Cost per useful outcome, support load, expansion, retention, infrastructure cost

DAY-120 DECISION

Confirm the platform thesis, revise it with evidence, and commit to the next operating horizon with explicit bets, owners, thresholds, dependencies, and stop conditions.